

NBC · NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

VILLAGE TABLE

Stamped bottle caps and a retired phone that turn children's hands-on play into skill records their families own.

Built by Algo Peers · Sam Quansah, founder · Pre-seed · September 2026

PROBLEM

MOST CHILDREN LEARN AT TABLES, NOT SCREENS. NONE OF IT IS RECORDED.

- Ghana now requires every child to learn computing. Most schools have few working computers.
- When a child works something out with their hands, nothing is kept. Teachers can't see who is ready for what, and parents get nothing to hold on to.
- AI learned from what people wrote. It has almost no record of how people reason with real objects.

SOLUTION

A TABLE THAT SEES THE STONES, NOT THE CHILDREN

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Stones

Bottle caps, clay or wood with a stamped code. A village can make its own.

~\$3

Game cloth

A printed cloth sets the task. Lay a new cloth to play a new game.

\$0

Lamp

A retired phone above the table reads every move. No microphone. No images kept.

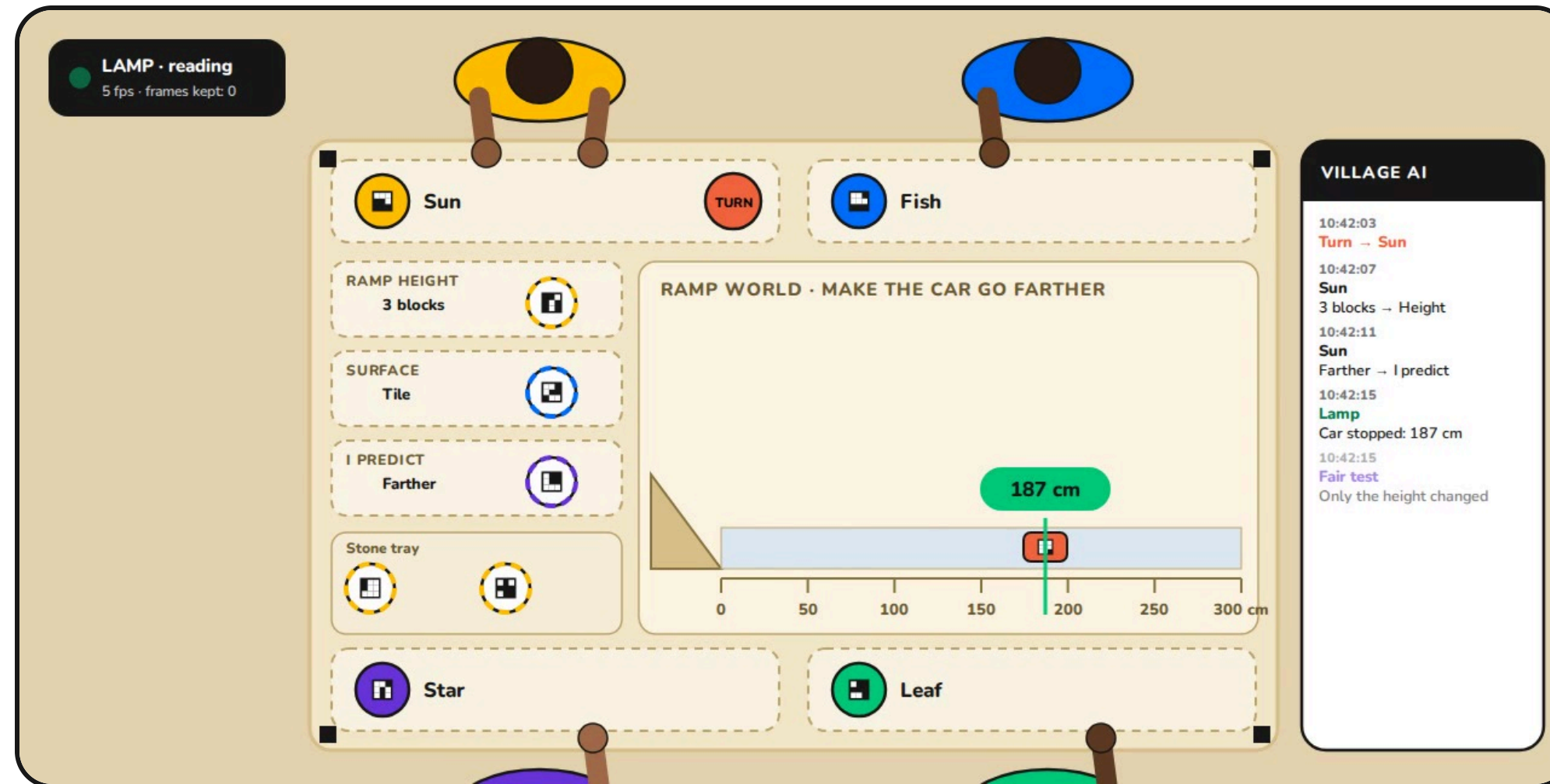
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New servers

The school AI runs on staff phones and keeps each child's skill record.

Our promise: no images, voices or names are stored. Children's data is never sold. Families own the record.

HOW IT WORKS



- 1 Children pass a turn stone, so every move has an owner.
- 2 They run a real experiment: roll a car down a ramp.
- 3 The lamp reads each move and where the car stops.
- 4 The child's record updates: "changes one thing at a time".
- 5 Same skill in a new game? It carries over.

From our prototype, which uses simulated data. Reading real stones with a real camera is our first build task.

WHY NOW

THREE THINGS CHANGED

Old phones are everywhere

A retired smartphone can read printed codes on the device, offline, for free.

Computing became compulsory

Ghana's schools must now teach computing, with no simple way to show children are learning it.

AI is moving into the physical world

AI labs need tests of how people reason with objects, and real human results to compare against.

TRACTION

FIVE YEARS OF TRUST. ONE MONTH OF PRODUCT.

Algo Peers, since 2021 · Cape Coast, Ghana

- 1,000+ children reached through our programmes
- Families pay for our after-school sessions
- \$93,511 in grants, including Global Affairs Canada
- 31 public schools assessed (11,214 students)

Village Table, started September 2026

- Working software prototype and live demo
- An open format for describing each game
- No pilots, users or revenue yet
- First pilot: 3 sites, by March 2027

BUSINESS MODEL

ONE TABLE, THREE CUSTOMERS

Now

Schools and after-school clubs

Kits, a yearly subscription per facilitator (\$120–180 to start), and licences for small independent schools.

Now

AI labs

Tests of physical reasoning built from our games, with results from paid adult testers. Never children's data.

Later

Funders and governments

Pay for results, per verified skill a child shows.

Prices are plans to test in the pilot. Families always use the table for free.

MARKET

WHAT YEAR 2 LOOKS LIKE: \$1.5M

3 AI lab testing contracts × \$400K	\$1,200K
Kits and materials	\$100K
10 small independent schools × \$8K licence	\$80K
500 facilitators × \$150 a year	\$75K
First pay-for-results pilot	\$20K
Total	\$1,475K

Start: after-school clubs and private schools in Cape Coast, where Algo Peers already works. **Then:** the rest of Ghana, then similar markets. AI labs pay first, while school revenue builds.

COMPETITION

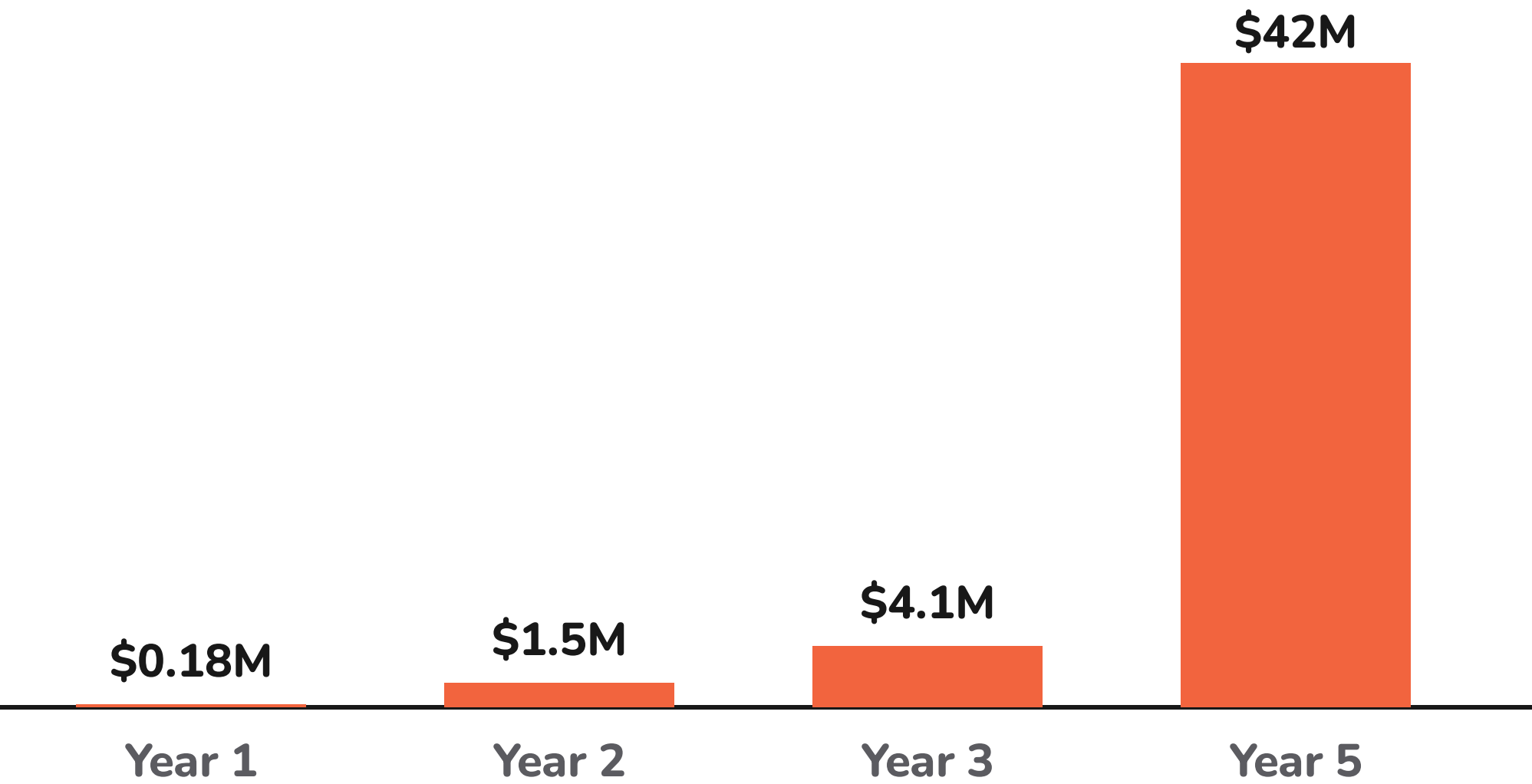
NOBODY RECORDS WHAT CHILDREN DO WITH THEIR HANDS

	WORKS WITHOUT SCREENS	CHEAP PER CHILD	KEEPS A SKILL RECORD
Tablet and AI tutor apps	No	No	Screen only
Robotics and coding kits	Yes	No	No
Exams and tests	Yes	Yes	Recall only
Village Table	Yes	Yes	Yes

What we know: in most of the world, learning happens at tables. The objects must be free; the intelligence goes in the room.

FORECAST

REVENUE PLAN (BASE CASE)



Targets from our model, not results.
Year 4 is not modelled.

Year 5 range: **\$15M to \$68M.**

Early revenue leans on AI lab contracts.
We cap them at half of revenue from
year 3.

MILESTONES

WHAT WE WILL PROVE, AND WHEN

Next 12 weeks

The lamp reads real stones (98%+ correct). Two game cloths. School AI on staff phones. Pilot at 3–5 sites.

By March 2027

80+ children playing weekly. 60%+ come back by choice. First published result on whether skills carry over. First paid contracts.

By month 12

Seed-ready: repeatable paid pilots, a second country, and a returning AI lab customer.

If the camera or the return rate fails, we switch: a no-camera NFC board, or new games.

TEAM

BUILT BY THE PEOPLE ALREADY IN THE ROOM

Sam Quansah · Founder

- Founded Algo Peers in 2021 in Cape Coast, starting in a four-square-metre maker space
- Ed.M., Harvard Graduate School of Education (2027)
- 2024 Mandela Washington Fellow · Harvard i-lab member
- Cape Coast team runs programmes day to day

Hiring first

- Technical co-founder: computer vision and embedded systems
- Learning-science lead
- Head of trust and data protection

THE ASK

RAISING A PRE-SEED ROUND

35%

People: engineering and learning science

20%

Pilots and facilitators

15%

AI test lab, incl. paid adult testers

30%

Product, legal and data trust, reserve

This takes us to the March 2027 milestones and a seed round. Round details on request.